

Al Noor General Hospital

Staff Handbook

Version 3.0 | Effective January 2026 | Sample document for testing

1. Welcome, Mission and Employment Categories

1.1 Welcome. Welcome to Al Noor General Hospital. This handbook explains what we expect from every employee and what you can expect from the hospital. Please read it during your first week and keep it for reference.

1.2 Mission and values. Our mission is to provide safe, compassionate and high-quality care to every patient. Our values are respect, integrity, teamwork, excellence and accountability.

1.3 Employment categories. Full-time employees work the standard working week described in this handbook. Part-time employees work an agreed number of hours and receive leave in proportion to those hours. Temporary and locum staff are covered by the terms of their individual contracts.

1.4 Employment contract. Your contract states your job title, department, salary, working hours and notice period. If this handbook and your contract differ on a point of pay or notice, the contract applies. On all other matters in this handbook, the handbook applies.

1.5 Equal opportunity. The hospital does not discriminate on the basis of nationality, religion, gender, age or disability. Harassment and bullying are not tolerated, and any employee may report them under the grievance procedure in section 10.

1.6 Related documents. Clinical rules are set in the Patient Care and Safety Policy Manual and infection prevention rules in the Infection Control and Occupational Health Policy. Where this handbook repeats a rule from those documents, the rule is the same.

2. Working Hours, Shifts and Attendance

2.1 Working week. Full-time staff work 8 hours per day, 6 days per week. Rotas are published at least 2 weeks in advance by the department head.

2.2 Standard shifts. The three standard shifts are Morning (7:00 AM to 3:00 PM), Evening (3:00 PM to 11:00 PM) and Night (11:00 PM to 7:00 AM). Administrative departments may have different hours, which are stated in the contract.

2.3 Clocking in. Staff must clock in and out using the biometric system at the start and end of each shift. Clocking in for another person is a serious disciplinary offence.

2.4 Handover. Clinical staff attend the shift handover, which takes place in the 15 minutes before the end of the shift. A shift is not finished until the handover is complete.

2.5 Shift swaps. A shift swap must be approved by the department head at least 48 hours in advance. The staff member who accepts a swap becomes responsible for the shift.

2.6 Lateness and absence. If you cannot come to work or will be late, you must telephone your department head as early as possible and at least 2 hours before the start of the shift, except in emergencies. Repeated lateness is managed under the disciplinary procedure.

2.7 Breaks. Staff working an 8-hour shift receive a 30-minute meal break. Staff must not leave the ward without telling the nurse in charge.

3. Probation and Performance Review

3.1 Probation period. The probation period for all new employees is 6 months. During probation, either side may end the employment by giving the notice stated in the contract.

3.2 Reviews. Performance is reviewed with your line manager after month 3 and again after month 6. The reviews cover attendance, quality of work, teamwork, patient feedback and completion of mandatory training.

3.3 Outcome. At the end of probation, the employee is confirmed in the post, the probation is extended once for up to 3 months with clear targets, or the employment is ended.

3.4 Leave during probation. Staff on probation may not take more than 5 consecutive days of annual leave. Leave still builds up during probation as described in section 4.

3.5 Annual appraisal. After probation, every employee has an annual appraisal. The employee and the manager agree on objectives for the next year and a training plan.

3.6 Support. Employees who are finding the work difficult can ask for extra support, a buddy or additional training at any time. They do not need to wait for a review.

4. Annual Leave and Public Holidays

4.1 Entitlement. New joiners are entitled to 14 days of paid annual leave in their first year of service. From the second year onwards, employees receive 22 days of paid annual leave per year.

4.2 Requesting leave. Leave must be requested through the HR portal at least 14 days before the planned leave. The department head approves or declines the request, based on staffing levels, within 5 working days.

4.3 Peak periods. Leave may be limited during peak periods such as holidays and the influenza season. Requests for these periods are decided fairly, and staff who did not have leave in the same period the previous year are given priority.

4.4 Public holidays. Public holidays follow the official UAE calendar. Staff who work on a public holiday receive either another day off or extra pay, as stated in their contract.

4.5 Carrying forward. A maximum of 5 unused days of annual leave can be carried forward to the next year with the written approval of the department head. Other unused days lapse unless the contract says otherwise.

4.6 Leave on leaving. Employees who leave the hospital are paid for any annual leave they have earned but not taken, up to the date of leaving.

4.7 Cancelling leave. The hospital may only cancel approved leave in an emergency. Staff will be reimbursed for any non-refundable costs they can prove.

5. Sick, Maternity, Paternity and Emergency Leave

5.1 Sick leave notification. You must tell your department head as soon as possible if you are sick and cannot come to work.

5.2 Medical certificate. A medical certificate from a licensed doctor is required for sick leave longer than 2 consecutive days. The certificate must be given to HR on or before the day of return.

5.3 Return after infectious illness. Staff who have been ill with an infectious illness must contact Occupational Health before returning to patient areas. Staff with diarrhoea or vomiting must stay away from work until they have had no symptoms for 48 hours.

5.4 Maternity leave. Female employees are entitled to 60 calendar days of maternity leave. Employees should inform HR of the expected date of birth at least 8 weeks before the date.

5.5 Paternity leave. Male employees are entitled to 5 working days of paid paternity leave, which may be taken within the first month after the birth of the child.

5.6 Emergency and compassionate leave. Emergency leave for serious family events, such as the death of a close relative, is approved by the department head and recorded by HR. The length depends on the situation and the contract.

5.7 Unpaid leave. Unpaid leave may be approved by the Director of HR in special circumstances and is never guaranteed.

6. Dress Code and Professional Conduct

6.1 Identification. All staff must wear their hospital ID badge where it can be seen, at all times while on duty. A lost badge must be reported to HR on the same day.

6.2 Uniform. Clinical staff wear the uniform of their department, which must be clean, ironed and in good condition. Uniforms are not worn outside the hospital. Administrative staff wear smart business clothing.

6.3 Hygiene and appearance. Hair must be tidy and tied back in clinical areas. Nails must be short and clean, and artificial nails are not allowed in clinical areas. Jewellery must be minimal, and rings with stones are not worn when caring for patients.

6.4 Footwear. Closed, non-slip shoes are required in all patient care areas.

6.5 Conduct towards patients and visitors. Staff must be polite, patient and respectful. Staff must follow the visiting rules in a courteous way, and must call hospital security on extension 100 if a visitor is aggressive, and must not argue with the visitor.

6.6 Conduct towards colleagues. Staff must treat colleagues with respect and work as a team. Shouting, abusive language, bullying and harassment are serious misconduct.

6.7 Mobile phones. Personal mobile phones must not be used in patient care areas except for work purposes or during breaks. Staff must not take photographs of patients, records or screens.

7. Confidentiality, Records and Social Media

7.1 Confidentiality. All patient information is confidential. Staff may share information only with people who need it for the patient's care, or as required by law. Staff must not discuss patient details in public areas such as lifts, corridors or the cafeteria.

7.2 Access to records. Staff may open a patient's record only when they are involved in that patient's care. Every access to the electronic record is logged and audited, and unauthorised access is serious misconduct.

7.3 Retention. Medical records are kept for 25 years. Staff must never destroy or remove original records. Patients' requests for copies of their records are sent to the Medical Records office, which responds within 5 working days.

7.4 Passwords. Passwords are personal and must never be shared. Staff must lock their computer screen when they leave it and log out at the end of the shift.

7.5 Social media. Staff must not post anything about patients, colleagues' private matters or hospital incidents on social media, even without names. Staff must not take or share photographs or videos taken inside patient areas.

7.6 Speaking to the media. Only the Corporate Communications office may speak to the media on behalf of the hospital. Staff who are contacted by a journalist must refer the request to that office.

7.7 Breach. A breach of confidentiality must be reported to the department head and the Quality Department immediately, so that the patient can be informed and the risk reduced.

8. Training and Competency

8.1 Induction. Every new employee completes a 5-day induction before working independently. The induction covers hospital policies, fire safety, infection control, patient safety, the electronic record and customer service.

8.2 Mandatory training. All staff complete mandatory training every year in fire safety, infection control, patient safety, confidentiality and manual handling. Mandatory training records are reviewed during the annual appraisal.

8.3 Basic Life Support. All clinical staff must hold a valid Basic Life Support (BLS) certificate, which is renewed every 2 years. Advanced Cardiac Life Support (ACLS) is required for doctors and nurses in the emergency department, the Intensive Care Unit and the cardiology ward.

8.4 Competency assessment. Clinical competencies, such as medication administration, are assessed when the employee joins and then every year by a senior colleague.

8.5 Professional licence. Doctors, nurses and other licensed professionals must keep their professional licence valid. HR must receive a copy of every renewal. Staff cannot work in a clinical role with an expired licence.

8.6 Continuing education. The hospital supports continuing professional development. Staff may request paid time and funding for courses that are linked to their role, and approvals depend on budget and service needs.

8.7 Records. The Learning and Development team keeps each employee's training records and sends reminders before certificates expire.

9. Incident Reporting, Health and Safety, and Fire

9.1 Incident reporting. Every patient safety incident, accident or near-miss must be reported in the incident reporting system within 12 hours of the event. A serious incident must also be reported verbally to the department head immediately.

9.2 No-blame culture. Staff who report incidents honestly and on time will not be punished for the report. The aim is to learn and to improve patient safety. Reports are reviewed by the Quality Department every week.

9.3 Needle-stick injuries. A needle-stick or sharps injury must be reported to the Infection Control Unit within 1 hour by calling extension 240, and the injured person must go to Occupational Health. The injury must also be entered in the incident reporting system within 12 hours.

9.4 Manual handling. Staff must use the correct manual handling techniques and the available equipment, such as hoists and slide sheets. Staff who are asked to lift a load that seems unsafe should ask for help.

9.5 Fire safety. Fire drills take place twice a year in every building. Staff follow the RACE steps: Rescue, Alarm, Contain and Extinguish or Evacuate. The assembly point is Car Park A.

9.6 Emergency numbers. Code Blue is extension 555, hospital security is extension 100, and the Infection Control Unit is extension 240. These numbers are shown on every staff ID card holder and on the back of every ward door.

9.7 Workplace violence. Staff who experience or witness violence or threats must move to safety, call security and report the event. The hospital supports staff who have been affected.

10. Grievances, Discipline, Pay and Overtime

10.1 Grievance procedure. An employee with a complaint should first speak to their line manager. If the issue is not solved in 10 working days, the employee can contact the HR department directly. HR will investigate and reply in writing.

10.2 Disciplinary procedure. Minor misconduct is managed in stages: a verbal warning, a written warning, and a final written warning. Serious misconduct, such as theft, patient abuse or a serious breach of confidentiality, may lead to immediate termination after an investigation.

10.3 Right to be heard. Before any disciplinary decision, the employee is told the allegation in writing and has the right to explain and to bring a colleague to the meeting.

10.4 Pay day. Salaries are paid by the last working day of every month by bank transfer. Payslips are available on the HR portal.

10.5 Overtime. Overtime must be approved by the department head in advance. Approved overtime is paid at 1.25 times the normal hourly rate, or as stated in the employee's contract.

10.6 Notice and leaving. Employees who wish to resign must give notice as stated in their contract. On the last day, the employee returns the ID badge, uniform and keys, and completes the exit clearance with HR.

10.7 Contacting HR. The HR department is on the second floor of the administration building. HR is open from Sunday to Thursday, and urgent matters outside these days can be sent to the duty manager.